

FOR BASEBALL & SOFTBALL COACHES

THE COACH'S GUIDE TO READING YOUR **GAMECHANGER** **STATS**

You already track every game. This is how to turn that 174-column export into faster, smarter coaching decisions — which stats matter, which to ignore, and how to set a lineup from the numbers.

THE 6 STATS WORTH YOUR TIME

GameChanger exports well over a hundred columns. For real coaching decisions in youth ball, these six carry most of the signal. Learn what each one is really telling you.

OBP

ON-BASE PERCENTAGE

How often a player reaches base — hits, walks, and hit-by-pitch. It rewards plate discipline, not just hits, so it's a truer picture of value than batting average.

- Your highest-OBP players belong at the top of the order.

OPS

ON-BASE PLUS SLUGGING

OBP plus slugging in one number — it blends getting on base with hitting for power. The single best one-glance measure of total offensive contribution.

- Rank your roster by OPS to see your real run producers.

QAB%

QUALITY AT-BAT %

The share of at-bats with a productive outcome — hard contact, a walk, a long count, moving a runner. It credits good process even when the result is an out. Gold for young hitters.

- A high QAB% with a low average means a hitter who's close — keep developing them.

BB/K

WALK-TO-STRIKEOUT RATIO

Walks divided by strikeouts — a clean read on plate discipline and strike-zone control. Trends up as a hitter matures.

- Rising BB/K is one of the best signs a young hitter is developing.

FPS%

FIRST-PITCH STRIKE % (PITCHERS)

How often a pitcher starts the batter 0-1. In youth ball it's the single biggest driver of success — strike-throwers control games. More predictive than ERA at this level.

- Your best FPS% arms are your most reliable starters, regardless of record.

WHIP

WALKS + HITS PER INNING (PITCHERS)

Baserunners allowed per inning. Less noisy than ERA, which swings wildly on a few errors or one bad inning in a short youth season.

- Compare arms on WHIP and FPS% before you trust ERA alone.

WHAT TO TRUST, WHAT TO TAKE WITH A GRAIN OF SALT

Watch out for small samples. Early in a season, a kid who's 3-for-5 shows a .600 average that means almost nothing. Give any rate stat time — a couple of weeks of at-bats — before you make a decision off it. The more at-bats (PA/AB) behind a number, the more you can trust it.

Batting average is overrated. It ignores walks entirely. A .250 hitter who walks a lot can create more runs than a .300 hitter who never does. Lead with OBP and OPS; treat average as a supporting number, not the headline.

ERA is noisy in youth ball. One error-filled inning can wreck it. For a fairer read on your pitchers, lean on first-pitch strike % and WHIP, and look at how many innings back up the number.

PART 3 · PUT IT TO WORK

BUILD A LINEUP FROM THE NUMBERS

A simple, defensible starting point — then adjust for what you know about your kids that the stats can't see.

SPOT	LOOK FOR	WHY
Leadoff	Highest OBP + speed	Their only job is to be on base when your bats come up.
2-hole	High OBP, good contact	Keeps the line moving and sets the table for power.
3 & 4	Highest OPS / SLG	Your run producers, up when runners are on.
5	Next-best power	Protects the cleanup spot, drives in runs.
6–9	Rising QAB% / contact	Developing bats — quality at-bats turn the lineup over.

Pick your practice focus from team weak spots. Add up the team: if first-pitch strike % is low, that's your bullpen block this week. If team QAB% is low, it's two-strike approach and pitch selection. Let the numbers choose the drill — not the loudest parent.

STOP DOING THIS BY HAND

SCOUT DASHBOARD DOES ALL OF THIS — AUTOMATICALLY

Everything in this guide — ranking by OPS, spotting rising QAB%, comparing arms, choosing the practice focus — takes one paste of your GameChanger export. No formulas, no sorting.

- ✓ Your whole roster ranked and role-tagged
- ✓ A data-backed batting order starting point
- ✓ Pitching workloads and strike-throwing at a glance
- ✓ Practice priorities flagged from your team's real weak spots
- ✓ A clean player card for every kid

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